

TOPIC:-

Indexes Management

⇒ Indexes are a crucial component for optimizing performance in Oracle database.

⇒ They function like an index in a book, allowing for faster retrieval of specific data. It is a memory object.

What are Indexes?

- Optional structures associated with tables and clusters.

- Speed up execution of SQL statements by providing a faster access path to data.

- Allows faster access to rows in a table when a small subset of the rows will be retrieved from the table.

- An index stores the value of the column or columns being indexed, along with the physical RowID of the row containing the indexed value.

- Indexes are logically and physically independent of the data of associated table.

- Indexes are created on a single column or multiple columns.

- Index entries are stored in a B-tree structures so that traversing the index to find the key value of the row uses very few I/O operations.

- Primarily means of reducing I/O on disk

Types of Indexes

⇒ There are the following types:

- B-Tree Indexes (balanced trees)

- These are the default type and work well for various queries.
- Data is organized in a tree-like structure for efficient searching.

- Ideal for selective queries.
- Useful on columns that appear in where clause.

- Bit-map Indexes

- Designed for data warehouses with large datasets and many filtering conditions. Appropriate on low cardinality columns.

- Use bitmaps to represent sets of rows that meet certain criteria.

- Efficient for queries with multiple WHERE clause conditions.
- When filtering on low cardinality columns.

- o It stores one string of bits for each possible value of the column being indexed.
- o Unique indexes

- o Ensures each indexed value appears only once in the table. Enforced by the database.

- o It is most common form of B-Tree index.

It is often used to enforce the primary key constraint of a table.

Ensures no duplicate values exist.

- o Non-Unique indexes

- o Allows for duplicate values in the indexed column(s). Useful for speeding up searches based on those columns.

- o Helps speed access to a table without enforcing uniqueness.

Additional Index Types

Function based indexes

- o Store precomputed values of functions applied to indexed columns.
- o Useful for speeding up queries involving functions on those columns.

It is same like to a standard B-index, except that a transformation of a column or columns, declared as an expression, is stored in the index instead of the columns themselves.

Useful in cases where names and addresses might be stored in the database as mixed case.

Besse key indexes

- o Orders the index entries in reverse order, beneficial for specific situations like sorting results in descending order. Useful for ^{when created or columns that contain sequential data}

- o Typically used in OLTP environment.

- o In Besse key index, all the bytes in each column's key value of the index are reversed.

Domain indexes

- o Used with Oracle cartridges for specific data types.

Management on indexes

1. Creating indexes:

[Note: sometimes on regulars]

o Explicit index creation:

Syntax

⇒ CREATE INDEX idx_customer_name
ON customers;

o Index with constraints:

Syntax

⇒ ALTER TABLE orders
ADD CONSTRAINTS PK-orders
PRIMARY KEY;

2. Monitoring indexes:

Identifying unused indexes:

Syntax

⇒ SELECT owner, index-name, last-analyzed
FROM user-indexes
WHERE last-analyzed IS NULL
OR
SYSDATE - last-analyzed

o monitoring fragmentation

o Over time, as data is inserted/deleted
or updated indexes can become fragmented.

o This reduces their effectiveness in
speeding up queries.

o monitoring fragmentation levels with
tools like DBMS_STATS helps determine
if rebuilding is necessary.

3. Altering indexes:

modifying storage characteristics:

⇒ By adjusting storage parameters
like tablespace placement or setting
fill factor to optimize index usage and
storage efficiently

Syntax

⇒ ALTER INDEX idx_customer_name
SET TABLESPACE idx-tpspace;

Rebuilding indexes:

Syntax

⇒ ALTER INDEX idx_products REBUILD;

making index usable/unusable

Syntax:

⇒ ALTER INDEX idx_orders DISABLE;

Syntax:

⇒ ALTER INDEX idx_orders ENABLE;

making index visible/unvisible

Syntax:

⇒ ALTER INDEX idx_customers VISIBLE FALSE;

ALTER INDEX idx_customers VISIBLE TRUE;

4. Dropping indexes:

Syntax:

⇒ DROP INDEX idx_old_data;
